

Dakhini Urdu: A Comparative Study

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Abstract

Dakhini Urdu exists in different forms in different places due to the cultural integration of the local majority languages. It serves as a symbol of local identity to complement both their regional identities while also associating with the super-ordinate Standard Urdu.

This paper intends to compare the dialects of Dakhini Urdu spoken in the regions of Bangalore and Hyderabad with the help of locals who speak the languages. It will also look into why Dakhini Urdu might be different from Standard Urdu.

Keywords: Bangalore, Dakhini Urdu, Hyderabad, Standard Hindi, Standard Urdu,

Introduction

Urdu holds a special place in India. It is a non-state language that holds official status in around six states in India- Telangana, Kashmir, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, and Karnataka. It is also one of the 22 scheduled languages in the Indian Constitution.

Since it is a non-state language, it is the language of many minorities across the country. While Urdu is a major language for the minorities, so just like any other speech community, there is a great variety in the language from different regions of India.

Dakhini Urdu, for example, while being a variety of Urdu spoken in Southern India, there exist variations within Dakhini. In the south, Dakhini is concentrated in a few regions, like Telangana and Karnataka. The Urdu language, as spoken in Karnataka and Telangana, though are the same language, the colloquial usages and slight variations in how it is spoken in both regions. This paper will go through some of the differences in the languages.

Standard Vs. Dakhini Urdu

Standard Urdu in itself is already a language that is influenced by many languages. Urdu is a mix of Persian, Arabic, Turkish, and Hindi to a great extent. Urdu is sometimes even referred to as a

*Standard Urdu(SU) is used interchangeably with Standard Hindi (Std. Hindi).

sister language to Hindi. It is a language almost exclusively spoken around India, in various regions.

Dakhini Urdu on the other hand, while being very close to the standard Urdu, is heavily influenced by the majority languages spoken in specific regions. Dakhini Urdu speakers are also known to be bilingual at least, due to them being in regions where Urdu is not actually a majorly spoken language.

Another major difference between the two is the way in which standard and Dakhini Urdu are used. While Dakhini Urdu is more used as a spoken, colloquial tongue, Standard Urdu is for used for all official purposes of writing.

Also to be considered that the very name “Dakhini” comes from the word “Deccan”, which means that Dakhini Urdu is a language spoken in the Deccan area of India, it is spoken in the South of India. Though Dakhini might have originated in the Delhi area and moved down south via Maharashtra, Karnataka, and then to the Andhra region. This is likely to have happened as Md. Tuglaq shifted his capital from Delhi to Daulatabad around the year 1327.

As Dakhini Urdu traveled south, many languages became an unconscious part of the language, like Khadi Boli, Awadhi, and others. This language finally made it to the Deccan when the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb expanded his territory.

Influence of Telugu on Dakhini Urdu

When Dakhini reached the Andhra region, it was still old enough that it had not been influenced by the local languages of Telugu in Andhra. A few similarities will be mentioned below. The influence has been mostly grammatical and structural.

There will be a comparison between Standard Urdu (SU)*, Telugu (TE), and Dakhini Urdu (DU)

- a. “Vaisaa” in DU translates to “aTTu” in TE, a form which does not exist in Standard Urdu (SU)

It looks like it will rain	Vaana occeT aTTu undi
	Paani pare vaisaa hai

- b. Both TE and DU have similar-sounding echo words that are not found in SU.

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SU khaana vaana
 Chaai vaai

In SU, the most used component for forming the echo words are “V”

In contrast, in both TE and DU, the most used component is “G”, This is obviously derived from Telugu itself, as standard Urdu does not have the concept of using the “g” sound.

TE dabbu gibbu
 Illu gillu

DU khaana giinaa
 Suit giit

- c. First person plural pronouns exist in both Telugu and Dakhini Urdu, but not in Standard Urdu

Exclusive “we”	DU	Hum logan	TE	Mem
Inclusive “we”	DU	Apan logan	TE	Manam

Dakhini Urdu in Hyderabad Vs. Bangalore

Dakhini Urdu, as previously mentioned, had variations within itself, and they spread across the many regions south of India. These include the regions of Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and Maharashtra. The differences between the way Dakhini is spoken in all regions are many. However, the paper will concentrate on the specific areas of Hyderabad and Bangalore.

1. Give it to Salim and come.

English	Salim	to	give	come
Std. Hindi	Salim	ko	deke	aao

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DU. Hyd.	Salim	ku	dedeke	aao
DU. Blr.	Salim	Ko	Dekh ko	aao

There is clear differentiation between all three ways of speaking.

a. “Ko” vs “ku”

In standard Hindi and DU from Bangalore, the difference in how they say “Ko” is not there, whereas in DU from Hyderabad, the slight difference, which is the pronunciation of the /u/ is present.

b. “Deke”, “Dedeke”, and “dekh ko”

It's a very simple differentiation between the three languages.

The root in each word remains the same, which in this case is “De”.

DU Hyd.: there is a repetition of the root word and is attached to the “ke” later on, forming the word dedeke.

DU Blr.: there is a complete difference in this, where it is not the same as either other language, in any way. “Dekh ko” in Std. Hin. would mean something entirely different. This shows slight difference in vocabulary in DU Blr. and Std. Hin., and DU Hyd.

2. I like the house you bought.

This line requires differentiation in all three languages as they are different enough so that they are not able to be put on a similar roster as either of the other two.

Eng.	which	House	you	bought	that	I	like
Std. Hin	Jo	ghar	aapne	kharida	woh	mujhe	pasand hai

Eng.	you	bought	which	house	I	Like
DU. Hyd.	Aap	kharide	so	ghar	Merku	Pasand hai

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Eng.	which	house	You	bought	—	That	I	like
DU. Blr	Jo	Ghar	aap	kharide	naa	Woh	munjhe	pasand

- a. In both Std. Hindi and DU Blr., the sentence structure is very similar, the only difference being the pronoun. This difference in pronoun also exists in DU Hyd.

Std. Hindi. **Mujhe**

DU Blr. **Munjhe**

DU Hyd. **Merku**

- b. The second difference is why there is a difference in sentence structure between DU Blr., Std. Hindi and DU Hyd.

The word “so” here, is equivalent to the Hindi “jo” meaning “which”. Though the word itself exists in all three forms of the language, the difference is that the DU Hyd. the “so” comes after the verb, whereas in DU Blr. and Std. Hindi, they arrive at the beginning of the sentence.

3. Bring the book from there

Eng.	From there	go	book	Bring	come
Std. Hindi	Udhar	jaake	Kitaab	leke	aao
DU Hyd	Waha se	jaake	kitaab	leleke	aao
DU. Blr	udhar	se	kitaab	leko	aao

Here again, while the structure remains mostly similar, the difference that can be spotted is the usage of the word “leke”.

Std. Hindi **leke**

DU Hyd. **leleke**

DU Blr. **leko**

1. DU Hyd.: As seen earlier, in DU Hyd., we can see the root word “le” being used twice after which the suffix “ke” is added.

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2. DU Blr.: The suffix “**ke**” that remains in both DU Hyd. and Std. Hindi is replaced with “**ko**”

4. He is going tomorrow

English	He	tomorrow	going
Std. hindi	woh	kal	jaayega
DU Hyd	Une (M)	kal	jaara
DU Blr	Uno (M)	sabaan	jaatein

The sentence structure in all three are the same, with no disruptions from any of them.

The difference lies in the pronouns and verb.

- a. Pronouns used in DU and Std. Hindi.

Std. Hindi **woh**

DU Hyd. **une**

DU Blr. **uno**

The words “**une**” and “**uno**” are used in both variations of DU, where the word is used to refer to another in the third person singular. This is a word developed with DU and does not exist in standard form Hindi at all, in which the word “**woh**” is used.

Another thing is that “**woh**” is used regardless of honorifics, but in both versions of DU, “**uno**” is formal while “**une**” is informal.

- b. Verb forms in DU Hyd., DU Blr., and Std Hindi.

Std. Hindi **jaayega**

DU Hyd. **jaara**

DU Blr. **jaatein**

The root word in all 3 remain the same, the word “**jaa**”. The suffixes change in every one. “**Ega**”, “**ra**” and “**tein**” are the differentiations between all three.

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- c. The last is another difference in vocabulary in DU Blr., which is the word “**sabaan**”, a word not found in either of the other variations.

5. Gopal is there

English	Gopal	Over there	is
Std. Hindi	Gopal	Udhar hi	hai
DU Hyd	Gopal	Udharich	hai
DU Blr	Gopal	wanch	hai

- a. The sentence structure once again is very similar, and the only difference lies in the vocabulary.
- b. The word with differences in this line is “over there”

Std. Hindi **Udhar hi**

DU Hyd. **Udharich**

DU Blr. **Wanch**

The root remains the same, “**Udhar**”. What changes in DU Hyd., is the suffix. In Std Hindi, the “**hi**” is a copula. In DU Hyd., the suffix “**ich**” is widely used to the same effect as the “**hi**” in Std. Hindi.

The word “**wanch**” in DU Blr., is again vocabulary with no similarities with the other two variations, though one might interpret it as “**wahi ich**”.

6. We don’t do that

English	we	people	Like that	no/don’t	do
Std. Hindi	Hum	log	waise	nahi	karte
DU. Hyd	Humla		aisa	nai	karte
DU. Blr	hume	logaan	waise	nai	karte

The sentence structure is the same in all three.

- a. The manner of saying “we people” in each differs.

Std. Hindi **Hum log**

DU Hyd. **Humla**

DU Blr. **Hum logaan**

The “**hum**” remains same throughout, but the manner in which the “**log**” is split between the three.

In DU Blr., “**aan**” is added to “**log**”

In DU Hyd. as well, the suffix “**aan**” is usually added, but in this case and many colloquial cases “**hum**” and “**logaan**” are put together for people to say “**humla**”

7. I want that toy

English	I	that	toy	want
Std. Hindi	Mujhe	woh	khilona	chahiye
DU. Hyd	Merku	wo	khilona	hona
DU Blr	Munjhe	wo	khilona	hona

Sentence structure is the same throughout.

- a. The difference in pronouns is once again present.
- b. The /h/ sound is lost in DU Hyd., and DU Blr. When spoken, this sometimes comes off as “**o**” instead of “**wo**”.
- c. The word for “**want**” is different in the case of DU Hyd. and DU Blr.

Std. Hindi **chahiye**

DU Hyd. **hona**

DU Blr. **hona**

The word “**hona**” exists in both DU Hyd. and DU Blr. but does not exist in Std. Hindi.

8. Did he do something wrong?

English	he	something	wrong	did	what
Std. hindi	Usne	kuch	galat	Kiya	kya

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DU. Hyd	Une (M)	kuch	Gicchi	Kiya	Kya
DU. Blr	Une (M)	Kya tabhi	galath	Kariya?	

There are differences in vocabulary in both variants of DU as compared to Std. Hindi.

- The word “**gicchi**” does not exist in the vocabulary of both Std. Hindi and DU Blr.
- The word “**kariya**” is not used in Std. Hindi and DU Hyd.

In DU Hyd, the /g/ sound in “**galath**” is sometimes pronounced as /kh/ or /gh/.

9. Why did Sita do that?

English	Sita	has	Like that	why	did
Std. Hindi	Sita	ne	waisa	kyu	kiya

English	Sita	why	Did (F)	Like that
DU. Hyd.	Sita	kaiku	Kari	waisa?

English	Sita	why	Like that	Did (F)
DU Blr	Sita	kaiku	waisa	Kari so?

The sentence structure is the same in both variations of DU but is different from Std. Hindi.

- The word “**kaiku**” does not exist in Std. Hindi but does in both DU variations. It holds the same meaning as “**kyu**”.
- The phrase “**kari so**” is new, and the application of the word “**so**” is similar to DU Hyd. as previously mentioned.

10. Sita went to Gopal

English	Sita	Gopal	to/near/to where		Went	Was (F)
Std. Hin	Sita	Gopal	Ke	paas	Gayi	Thi
DU. Hyd	Sita	Gopal	Kane		gayiwi	thi
DU. Blr	Sita	Gopal	Ke	paas	Gayi	thi

- The word “**kane**” does not exist in variations of DU Blr. and Std Hindi. It holds the same meaning as “**near that**” or “**to where**”.
- The word “**gayiwi**” is a mix between the words “**gayi hui**” which is std. Hindi for “**had gone**”. If one were to say “Sita Gopal ke paas gayi hui thi” that would hold the same meaning as “Sita Gopal ke paas gayi thi”. So “**gayiwi**” is a variation of that.

Conclusion

There are evidences of all three, Std. Hindi, DU Hyd., and DU Blr. are influenced by each other on a big enough scale that they are mutually intelligible to a certain extent. There are influences of many languages within Dakhini Urdu as a whole and that change and influence is taken slowly into higher concentration when the Dakhini Urdu is regionalized further, like in Bangalore and Hyderabad. In this paper, the differences have been explained through examples that were given and translated by native Dakhini Urdu speakers from these particular regions. The similarities have also been recorded. There are as many similarities as there are differences. There could be reasons why such differences exist in the first place and where they newer vocabulary came from, in words like “kaiku”, “gicchi”, “munjhe”, “wanch” and so on. These words have no base in the other languages, so they could be authentic Dakhini words or be derived from others. There is yet much to be explored on the regional impacts on Dakhini Urdu.

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